Paola Mejia

Co-Founder & CTO, Scholé AI · PhD in Computer Science, EPFL · Lausanne, Switzerland
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EXPERIENCE

2025–present — **Co-Founder & CTO**, Scholé AI, Lausanne
AI personalised learning platform for workforce upskilling. Lead product and engineering for an agentic system that adapts to a learner's role, workflow and organisational context. Raised a $3M seed round led by ACE Ventures; built and scaled the engineering team. IATSE Local 891 pilot: members' self-rated confidence with AI tools rose from 3.5 to 5.6 out of 10 across 1,200+ activities. OSTraining: launched their own AI learning platform on Scholé, September 2026. Product Hunt: #1 Product of the Day, twice. Partners: Swisscom and Decathlon; Kickstart Innovation 2025.

2026–present — **Guest Lecturer**, Harvard Data Science Review Courses, Online
Teaches in the Harvard Data Science Review intensives, run with NGL, leading live sessions on building AI agents for professionals.

2024 — **Visiting Researcher**, Centre for Learning Analytics at Monash (CoLAM), Melbourne
Hosted as a collaborator of Roberto Martinez-Maldonado. Ran a large-scale study on how data storytelling affects task performance across levels of cognitive complexity, and studied multimodal dashboards for team-teaching reflection.

2021–2024 — **Research Lead, Lernnavi studies**, Lernnavi · EPFL ML4ED, Switzerland
Lernnavi is a tutoring system that Swiss high-school students use to practise German and maths. I led our classroom studies: classes took a pre-test and survey, learned with Lernnavi for about two months, then took a post-test and second survey, so we could compare what students *said* about their self-regulated learning with what they *did*. A follow-up experiment tested personalised self-regulated learning messages in the platform. Paper: *Navigating Self-regulated Learning Dimensions* (AIED 2024).

2020–2025 — **Doctoral Researcher**, EPFL ML4ED, Lausanne
Machine Learning for Education Laboratory, advised by Tanja Käser. EDIC Fellowship; EPFL IC Distinguished Service Award; Vice-President of the IC PhD Association (EPIC).

2019–2020 — **Junior Researcher**, Data Science Center, ITAM, Mexico City
Advised by Adolfo de Unanue and Liliana Millán, at the spin-off of Data Science for Social Good (University of Chicago / CMU). Built a university-dropout early-prediction model and the AWS infrastructure serving it in real time.

2018–2020 — **Research Assistant**, Economic Research Center (CIE), Mexico City
Advised by Enrique Seira and Mauricio Romero. Worked with the World Bank and Mexico's Central Bank to identify schools at risk of declining performance, and analysed internal migration patterns from the electoral register, 2009–2018.

EDUCATION

2025 — **PhD, Computer Science**, EPFL, Lausanne
Advisor: Tanja Käser. Thesis: *Personalizing Learning and Empowering Educators through Multi-Dimensional Clustering, Teacher Dashboards, and AI-Hybrid Learning Systems*.

2020 — **MSc, Data Science**, ITAM, Mexico City
Thesis advisors: Enrique Seira, Mauricio Romero. XXVI Research Award Ex-ITAM.

2019 — **BSc, Computer Engineering**, ITAM, Mexico City
Thesis advisor: Salvador Marmol. *Flecha al aire* Award 2019.

CERTIFICATE PROGRAMS

2019 **Innovation and Entrepreneurship Program**, ITAM and Grupo BAL, Mexico City
Final project on technology for the mining sector, presented to Grupo BAL's CEO.

2019 **Summer School on Social Innovation and Financial Inclusion in the Digital Age**, Georgetown University, McDonough School of Business, Washington DC
Fully funded. Designed an app for financial literacy; best final presentation award.

2018 **Summer School on Applied Data Science, with Raja Sooriamurthi**, Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College, Pittsburgh
Project on household poverty prediction in Costa Rica.

2018 **Academic Exchange**, University of New South Wales, Sydney

2017 **Next Generation Enterprise Modeling in the Digital Transformation Age Summer School**, University of Vienna, Vienna

AWARDS

2026 **Tech Tour AI & Trust Systems**
selected startup, September 2026

2026 **#1 Product of the Day, Product Hunt**
two launches of Scholé

2025 **Innosuisse grant**
for research development of adaptive learning systems (Scholé)

2024 **Tools Competition winner**
Building an Adaptive and Competitive Workforce (Scholé)

2024 **Best Paper Award**
ECTEL: *AI or Human? Evaluating Student Feedback Perceptions*

2024 **Best Late-Breaking Results Award**
AIED: *Interpret3C*

2022 **EPFL IC Distinguished Service Award**
as Vice-President of the IC PhD Association

2022 **EDIC Fellowship**
EPFL doctoral programme in Computer and Communication Sciences

2021 **XXVI Research Award Ex-ITAM**
first place, computer engineering

2020 **ANFEI Academic Excellence Award**
National Association of Faculties and Schools of Engineering

2019 ***Flecha al aire* Award**
best undergraduate thesis related to education

PUBLICATIONS

2026 **AI-Driven Analytics of Team-Teaching Talk: Acoustic Patterns Across Experience, Cohorts and the Learning Design**
Yuchen Liu, Roberto Martínez-Maldonado, Riordan Alfredo, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Dwi Rahayu, Sadia Nawaz. *Lecture Notes in Computer Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-032-29763-1_1

2026 **Turning 500+ Students into Teachers: A Semester-Long Study of an AI Teachable Agent in an Undergraduate Algorithms Course**
Chenyang Wang, Christopher Petrie, Miltiadis Stouras, Nicolas Ettlin, Amaury George, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Tanja Käser, et al.. *ACM Conference on Learning @ Scale (L@S '26)*. doi:10.1145/3774398.3811623

2026 **Making machine learning findings accessible to teachers in blended classrooms**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Seyed Parsa Neshaei, Eva Laini, Tanya Nazaretsky, Peter Bühlmann, Tanja Käser. *International Journal of Artificial Intelligence in Education*. doi:10.1016/j.ijaied.2026.100001

2026 **Scenario-Based Learning Through and with AI: Evidence-Informed Simulations for Education Leaders**
Ella Hamonic, Candy Lugaz, Annina Demirag, Rémi Sharrock, Agustina Thailinger, Maria Victoria Picchio, Vinitra Swamy, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**. *Communications in Computer and Information Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-032-29794-5_24

2025 **Who Gives Feedback Matters: Student Biases Towards Human and AI-Generated Formative Feedback**
Tanya Nazaretsky, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Jibril Frej, Tanja Käser. *Journal of Computer Assisted Learning*. doi:10.1111/jcal.70153

2025 **Behavioural transitions in team teaching**
Yuchen Liu, Sadia Nawaz, Mohammed Saqr, Sonsoles López-Pernas, Riordan Alfredo, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Dwi Rahayu, Roberto Martínez-Maldonado. *ASCILITE*. doi:10.65106/apubs.2025.2634

2025 **BloomTutor: Retrieval Augmentation for Bloom's Taxonomy Question Generation**
Yannis Laaroussi, Vinitra Swamy, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Adrien Vauthey, Aybars Yazici, Maxime Perrot, Tanja Käser. *EPFL Infoscience*.

2025 **Metacognition meets AI: Empowering reflective writing with large language models**
Seyed Parsa Neshaei, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Richard L. Davis, Tanja Käser. *British Journal of Educational Technology*. doi:10.1111/bjet.13601

2025 **User-centric Reflective Writing Assistance: Leveraging RAG for Enhanced Personalized Support**
Seyed Parsa Neshaei, Matea Tashkovska, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Thiemo Wambsganß, Tanja Käser. *CHI '25 Extended Abstracts*. doi:10.1145/3706599.3719899

2025 **"Piecing Data Connections Together Like a Puzzle": Effects of Increasing Task Complexity on the Effectiveness of Data Storytelling Enhanced Visualisations**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Mikaela Milesi, Laura Brandl, Vanessa Echeverría, Yueqiao Jin, Dragan Gašević, Yi-Shan Tsai, Tanja Käser, et al.. *CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25)*. doi:10.1145/3706598.3714270

2025 **TeamTeachingViz: Benefits, Challenges, and Ethical Considerations of Using a Multimodal Analytics Dashboard to Support Team Teaching Reflection**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Riordan Alfredo, Vanessa Echeverría, Dwi Lestari Rahayu, Linxuan Zhao, Haya Alajlan, Zachari Swiecki, Tanja Käser, et al.. *Learning Analytics and Knowledge (LAK '25)*. doi:10.1145/3706468.3706475

2025 **The critical role of trust in adopting AI-powered educational technology for learning: An instrument for measuring student perceptions**
Tanya Nazaretsky, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Jibril Frej, Tanja Käser. *Computers and Education: Artificial Intelligence*. doi:10.1016/j.caeai.2025.100368

2024 **AI or Human? Evaluating Student Feedback Perceptions in Higher Education**
Tanya Nazaretsky, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Jibril Frej, Tanja Käser. *European Conference on Technology Enhanced Learning (ECTEL 2024)*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-72315-5_20

2024 **Student Answer Forecasting: Transformer-Driven Answer Choice Prediction for Language Learning**
Elena Grazia Gado, Tommaso Martorella, Luca Zunino, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Jibril Frej, Tanja Käser. *arXiv preprint*. doi:10.48550/arxiv.2405.20079

2024 **GELEX: Generative AI-Hybrid System for Example-Based Learning**
Aybars Yazici, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Jibril Frej, Tanja Käser. *CHI '24 Extended Abstracts*. doi:10.1145/3613905.3650900

2024 **Teaching and Measuring Multidimensional Inquiry Skills using Interactive Simulations**
Ekaterina Shved, Engin Bumbacher, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Manu Kapur, Tanja Käser. *Lecture Notes in Computer Science (AIED 2024)*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-64302-6_34

2024 **Enhancing Procedural Writing Through Personalized Example Retrieval: A Case Study on Cooking Recipes**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Jibril Frej, Seyed Parsa Neshaei, Luca Mouchel, Tanya Nazaretsky, Thiemo Wambsganß, Antoine Bosselut, Tanja Käser. *International Journal of Artificial Intelligence in Education*. doi:10.1007/s40593-024-00405-1

2024 **Interpret3C: Interpretable Student Clustering Through Individualized Feature Selection**
Isadora Salles, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Vinitra Swamy, Julian Blackwell, Tanja Käser. *Communications in Computer and Information Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-64315-6_35

2024 **Navigating Self-regulated Learning Dimensions: Exploring Interactions Across Modalities**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Tanya Nazaretsky, Simon Schultze, Jan Hochweber, Tanja Käser. *Lecture Notes in Computer Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-64299-9_8

2023 **Understanding Revision Behavior in Adaptive Writing Support Systems for Education**
Luca Mouchel, Thiemo Wambsganß, **Paola Mejia-Domenzain**, Tanja Käser. *Zenodo*. doi:10.5281/zenodo.8115766

2023 **Visualizing Self-Regulated Learner Profiles in Dashboards: Design Insights from Teachers**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Eva Laini, Seyed Parsa Neshaei, Thiemo Wambsganß, Tanja Käser. *Communications in Computer and Information Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-36336-8_96

2022 **Evolutionary Clustering of Apprentices' Self-Regulated Learning Behavior in Learning Journals**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Mirko Marras, Christian Giang, Alberto Cattáneo, Tanja Käser. *IEEE Transactions on Learning Technologies*. doi:10.1109/tlt.2022.3195881

2022 **Identifying and Comparing Multi-dimensional Student Profiles Across Flipped Classrooms**
Paola Mejia-Domenzain, Mirko Marras, Christian Giang, Tanja Käser. *Lecture Notes in Computer Science*. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-11644-5_8

PANELS AND TALKS

2026 Trust Valley Days panel: *Trusting What We Learn*, with leaders of UNIL, UNIGE and HEIG-VD, Lausanne

2026 Tech Tour AI & Trust Systems: investor pitch, one of 40 companies selected from 80+, Prilly

2026 Investor Day panel with Vinitra Swamy, moderated by Alessandra Agnello, ACE Ventures, Geneva

2026 EPFL Engineering Industry Day, Lausanne

2025 AI Breakfast panel: AI x Education, moderated by Adrian Locher, Merantix AI Campus, Berlin

2025 AIED: Enhancing Procedural Writing through Personalized Example Retrieval, Palermo

2025 CHI: Data storytelling and task complexity, Yokohama

2025 LAK: Multimodal analytics dashboards for team teaching, Dublin

2024 CHI: Generative AI for example-based learning in recipe writing, Honolulu

2024 CoLAM seminar: Understanding students' online behaviour, Melbourne

2023 ECML-PKDD tutorial: Responsible AI, Turin

2023 AIED: Teacher dashboards for visualising SRL profiles, Tokyo

2023 Swiss VET Conference: Writing assistance for chef apprentices, Winterthur

2022	AIED: Multi-dimensional clustering in flipped classrooms, Durham
2021	Swiss VET Conference: Chef apprentices' learning documentation, Lugano

TEACHING

Autumn 2026	**Build Your Agent intensive**, Harvard Data Science Review Courses, with NGL Guest lecturer. Leads live sessions where participants build a personal AI agent with Claude, ChatGPT or Copilot. Teaching two sessions of the Spanish-language intensive, Estratega y Constructor de IA, in December 2026.
Spring 2021–2025	**CS-421 Machine Learning for Behavioral Data**, EPFL Helped Tanja Käser build this master's course from scratch; designed tutorials, labs, homework and project assignments on real data, and supervised semester-long student projects.
Autumn 2021	**CS-401 Applied Data Analysis**, EPFL Guided students through a semester-long analysis project ending in a data story.
Autumn 2022, 2023	**CS-101 Advanced Information, Computation, Communication I**, EPFL Led a team of ten teaching assistants running weekly tutorials and quizzes.
2016–2019	**Mathematics Weekend School**, ITAM Construye (NPO), Mexico City Founded and ran a weekend maths programme for underprivileged children aged 6–14, leading ~24 volunteers teaching 160 students.

WORKSHOPS ORGANISED

Scenario-Based Learning through and with AI: Evidence-Informed Simulations for Education Leaders, AIED 2026, Seoul, with IIEP-UNESCO and Télécom Paris

Second International Tutorial & Workshop on Responsible Knowledge Discovery in Education, ECML-PKDD 2024

First International Workshop on User-Centered Practices of Knowledge Discovery in Educational Data, ACM UMAP 2024

First International Tutorial & Workshop on Responsible Knowledge Discovery in Education, ECML-PKDD 2023

STUDENTS SUPERVISED

2026	**Aaron Dinesh**, SEAL: Secure and Efficient Aggregation for Personalized Learning Semester Project
2026	**Maxime Ducourau**, ContextaViz: The Effect of Contextualization and Progressive Hints on Visualization Literacy Semester Project
2025	**Adrien Vauthey**, Creation and Evaluation of Knowledge Graph with Human in the Loop Semester Thesis
2025	**Yannis Laaroussi**, RAG with Knowledge Graphs for Context-Aware Content Creation Semester Project
2025	**Othmane Oudghiri**, Personalized Knowledge Graph Paths Semester Project
2025	**Yasmin Rahhal**, Knowledge Tracing with LLMs to Extract Student History in ITS Semester Project
2024	**Aybars Yazici**, Exploring the Effect of Generative AI in Example-Based Learning Semester Project
2024	**Matea Tashkovska**, Adaptive Reflection Assistance with Memory Semester Project

2024 **Amaury George**, Learning by Explaining: Results of a Longitudinal Large-Scale Classroom Study
Semester Project

2024 **Ali Mrad**, Analysis of Large-Scale Study on Personalized SRL Messages in Online Learning Platform
Summer Intern

2023 **Aybars Yazici**, Investigating the Effectiveness of AI-Generated Examples for Learning
Semester Project

2023 **Amine Atallah**, Clustering Multi-Variate Time Series and Transition Probabilities
Semester Project

2023 **Shashwat Gupta**, Active Learning for Text Classification
Semester Project

2023 **Isadora Salles**, Intrinsically Interpretable Clustering for Students in MOOCs
Summer Intern

2022 **Ghali Chraibi**, Analysis of SRL Behavior in Large-Scale Study with Lernnavi
Summer Intern

2022 **Eva Laini**, Analyzing and Visualizing Student Behavior in Flipped Classrooms
Master Thesis

2022 **Gioele Monopoli**, Multi-Class Prediction of Learning Journal Competencies
Semester Project

2022 **Luca Mouchel**, Analyzing Revision Behavior in Recipe Writing
Semester Project

2021 **Natasa Krco**, Exploring Self-Regulated Learning (SRL) Behavior in Language and Math Learning
Semester Project

2021 **Gonxhe Idirizi**, NLP Analysis of Learning and Performance Documentation Entries of Chef Apprentices
Semester Project

Updated 2026-11-03. The latest version is at https://paola-md.github.io/cv.pdf.